STEPHY RIEGA ESCALANTE

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EDUCATION

The University of Chicago — Chicago, IL
Graduate Student-at-Large: Real Analysis (A) — 2026

Pontifical Catholic University of Peru (PUCP) — Lima, Peru
Diploma of Specialization in Data Science for Social Sciences and Public Policy — 2023
BA in Economics, First Class Honours (ranked 3rd of 73) — 2022

Mathematics: Mathematics for Economists I–IV (avg. 16; multivariable calculus, linear algebra, optimization, differential equations)
Master's-level coursework: Advanced Econometrics: Cross-Section and Panel Data (17); Design and Evaluation of Social Policies (17; RCTs, DiD, RD, SCM)
Selected coursework: Econometrics I (20); Advanced Topics in Microeconomics (18; causal ML); Microeconomics II (17); Applied Statistics (17); Statistical Inference (15)
Grades on a 0–20 scale; 11 is the minimum passing grade.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied Microeconomics, Economics of Education, Labor, Development, Human Capital

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of Chicago Crime Lab and Education Lab — Chicago, IL
Research Analyst — *November 2023 – Present*

- **Policing Leadership Academy (PLA)** – Multi-site RCT evaluating commander-level leadership training in U.S. police departments. With Prof. Max Kapustin and Dr. Kailey White.
  - Lead randomization, data analysis and impact analysis of World Management Survey (WMS) outcomes; estimated the reliability of double-scored interviews (ICCs, weighted kappas, variance decomposition) to quantify attenuation and statistical power.
  - Built a national FBI–ACS dataset for eligibility screening; quantified NIBRS–SRS reporting differences in homicide data.
- **Personalized Learning Initiative (PLI)** – Large-scale multi-site RCTs evaluating high-dosage tutoring in U.S. public schools. With Prof. Jens Ludwig and Dr. Fatemeh Momeni.
  - Contributed to experimental design and impact estimation across districts; led the Miami-Dade analysis across years, harmonizing datasets and identification strategies for pooled estimation.
  - Identified and corrected a logic bug in the core modeling function affecting clustered standard errors; implemented multi-way clustering across sites and ran robustness, falsification and predictive tests.

Group for the Analysis of Development (GRADE) — Lima, Peru
Research Assistant; Research Intern — *Apr 2023 – Oct 2023; Feb 2021 – Jul 2021*

- Contributed to the design and pre-analysis plan of a remote math tutoring RCT in 60 schools in Ayacucho, published as Leon, Endo, Zoido and Suarez (2026). Co-developed and validated its survey instruments. With Prof. Juan Leon.
- Contributed to an impact evaluation of labor formalization interventions for micro-entrepreneurs in Brazil (with Prof. Martin Valdivia), and to machine learning tools for detecting corruption with Peru's Comptroller General.

Innovations for Poverty Action (IPA) — Lima, Peru
Research Analyst; Research Intern — *Nov 2021 – Mar 2023; Aug 2021 – Oct 2021*

- Contributed to the design, pre-analysis plans and data collection of RCTs evaluating social-emotional learning, growth mindset tutoring, and intimate partner violence prevention in El Salvador, Nicaragua and Peru; presented findings to government partners and supervised field implementation.
- Developed WhatsApp-based survey and monitoring systems (Twilio, Google APIs) and a nationwide campaign encouraging teachers to register for the public teacher-hiring exam.

RESEARCH

Riega, S. (2025). *Not One Less in the Labor Market: The Vulnerability of Women's Employment in Urban Peru in 2019.* CIES. [link]
Riega, S. (in progress). *Higher Floors, Same Risks? A Decade of Minimum Wage Increases and Labor Vulnerability in Urban Peru.* [abstract]
Leon, J. & Riega, S. (in progress). *Do Digital Learning Platforms Close or Widen Learning Gaps? Evidence from Khan Academy in Lima's Public Schools.* [abstract]
Acknowledged contributor: Leon, J., et al. (2026). *Remote Tutoring for Learning Recovery.* International Journal of Educational Development. [link] · Bhatt, M. P., et al. (2025). *PLI Interim Report: Findings from 2023–24.* UChicago Education Lab. [link]

HONORS AND AWARDS

First Place, XXXI CIES-UNFPA Annual Research Competition (2025) · PUCP Research Grant for Undergraduate Thesis (2020)

SKILLS

Programming: R (advanced), Stata, Python, SQL; Git, LaTeX, Quarto, SurveyCTO **Languages:** Spanish (native), English (fluent)